

ENGLISH LANGUAGE PAPER 4

PART A Group Interaction

Below is an extract from an online article about clutter and messiness:

Get rid of clutter!

Do you have a very messy bedroom filled with all sorts of things such as old books, clothes and magazines everywhere? Clutter takes up valuable space – not just in your surroundings, but in your head as well. Of the two, the psychological effect of clutter is more important. According to an expert, ‘When we clear the clutter out of a space, people breathe a sigh of relief. People feel lighter, more at peace, more focused.’

Experts believe this is because the human brain is not equipped to deal with so much stimulation. If there’s stuff everywhere you look, you are more likely to become stressed out and anxious. Clear out and organise your environment, and your mind can handle more things. Yes, there are physical dangers to clutter – you can easily trip and fall over things left on the floor. However, the psychological effects of clutter appear to be more serious because clutter could make you depressed without you realising it. A messy room is not a pleasant room.

Clearing the clutter and becoming organised is not easy. That’s because a lot of what we hold on to is weighed down by emotional baggage. People have a strong attachment to their stuff. It carries memories and feelings, reminds them of things they don’t do anymore, things that upset them at one time or made them happy.

Your group has been assigned to write an article for the school magazine about the effects of having too much clutter in the home. Discuss with your group what to include in the article. You may want to talk about:

- reasons why people are unwilling to throw things away
- the effects of having clutter in the home
- what to do with the unwanted items
- anything else you think is important

PART B Individual Response

1. How often do you clean your bedroom?
2. Do you have a messy bedroom?
3. Is it easy to keep your room tidy?
4. How would you feel if someone cleaned up your room?
5. Do you find it difficult to throw old things away?
6. Are you comfortable with clutter?
7. Do you place any sentimental value in old things?
8. Can de-cluttering improve your life?